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How MANIPAL HOSPITALS Are Leveraging AI To Cure CANCER



► IBM Watson ranks the various identified treatment options on the basis of their outcomes and similar use cases to make the recommendation

In August 2015, when the world was still contemplating the possible uses of artificial intelligence (AI), a team at Manipal Hospitals collaborated with IBM to bring about a breakthrough in cancer healthcare by implementing IBM Watson.

IBM Watson is a cognitive computing platform that has been taught

by Memorial Sloan-Kettering, New York, USA. It analyses the patient data to give information on the possible treatment options, helping oncologists to treat cases of breast, colorectal and lung cancer with greater accuracy.

There have been extensive efforts around the globe to constantly evolve cancer research for better

results. This also puts doctors under a lot of pressure to keep abreast with the latest findings and treatment methods while maintaining a huge amount of existing data and knowledge.

“IBM Watson plays a crucial role here. It ranks the various identified treatment options on the basis of their outcomes and similar use cases, and also provides links confirming evidence for each option. That helps oncologists to make the best choice to cure the case in hand. Watson for Oncology constantly learns from a very reliable and regularly updated repository of information—till date, more than 300 medical journals, 200 textbooks and over 15 million pages of text.”

“Watson for Oncology also delivers, for doctors’ consideration while treating a patient, related analysis in the form of administration information, as well as information regarding the different available drugs. Its cognitive learning ability lets it evolve all the time, so that the concerned doctors have access to peer reviewed studies, clinical guidelines and expert perspectives,” explains Venitha, managing director, IBM India.

Since the last one-and-a-half years, there has been an upsurge in the number of cases that have been successfully dealt with by doctors. Initially there was hesitation, but doctors are now willingly benefit-